

Worm

In certain parts of the sea, it feels like Christmas every day. Here, the seabed is covered in what looks like a tiny forest of Christmas trees, however, these are actually colourful worms! The “branches” are crowns of feathery tentacles, which the worms use to trap scraps of food drifting past. If they are surprised, the worms quickly draw their tentacles in, and the “forest” disappears.

Christmas tree worms are part of a large group of animals, called segmented worms, whose soft bodies have many sections. Segmented worms live almost everywhere. Some live under the ice in Antarctica, others live on boiling volcanic vents in the deep sea, while trillions of earthworms are packed into our planet’s soil.



Worms are full of water at high pressure, like the air in a tyre.